

Λάων ὁ κωμικός

Laon the Comic Poet on Boeotia and Character

eul_aid: gmm

Period: *Κλασική* Classical

Dialect: *Κοινή* Koine

Domain: *Κωμωδία* Comedy

Format: *Ἑμμετρος* Verse

Laon was a Greek comic poet who lived during the 4th or early 3rd century BCE, a period that saw the evolution of comedy from the Middle to the New style. Beyond this, no details of his life are known. He is an obscure figure, documented only through later quotations, and his work survives only in fragments.

According to the 2nd–3rd century CE writer Athenaeus, Laon wrote two comedies: **The Centaur** and **The Phrygian**. These titles suggest plays that may have involved mythological parody or ethnic humor, common themes of the time. The surviving fragments from these lost works merely mention specific foods, like a type of cake and a dish made of brains.

Laon's historical importance is as a representative of the many comic poets whose works did not survive antiquity. He is a fragmentary data point, showing how later scholars preserved minor authors by citing interesting details of daily life and language. His existence helps modern scholars understand the breadth and fragmentary nature of the Greek comic tradition beyond its most famous names.

Works (2)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα · On Boeotia and Character](#) · 5 passages
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